

MODEL PAPER
ACADEMIC AND BUSINESS WRITING – BATCH 2023.2

SECTION A

(30 marks)

Multiple Choice Questions – 30 in total

Questions will stem from every single lesson covered in class.

1. The main objective of communication is:

- A. control and management
- B. information and persuasion
- C. skill and personality development
- D. need

2. Effective managers and professionals are skilled at reading

- | | |
|-----------------|---------------------|
| A. places | C. management books |
| B. case studies | D. situations |

3. 7 C's of communication does not include:

- | | |
|-------------|--------------|
| A. complete | C. coherence |
| B. clever | D. correct |

4. The downward communication flow is from:

- A. a superior to a superior
- B. a subordinate to a superior
- C. a subordinate to a subordinate
- D. a superior to a subordinate

5. channel of communication is called the grapevine:

- | | |
|---------------|-------------|
| A. horizontal | C. informal |
| B. formal | D. vertical |

6. The following is (are) non-verbal communication

- A. Facial expression
- B. Appearance
- C. Posture
- D. All of the above

7. Body of a letter is divided into _____ parts.

- A. 1
- B. 2
- C. 3
- D. 4

8. As the communicator, you need to think of :

- A. objective
- B. style
- C. credibility
- D. above all

9. All 7 C's of communication can be applied to:

- A. oral communication
- B. written and non-verbal communication
- C. oral and verbal communication
- D. effective business communication

10. The form of communication used most of the time for written messages to people within your organization.

- A. Memorandum
- B. Business letter
- C. Pamphlet
- D. Adjustment letter

SECTION B

Academic Writing – 3 questions in total

Q1. Include a topic sentence for the following paragraphs:

(10 marks)

1. Topic: Environmental Conservation

..... It involves efforts to protect ecosystems, reduce pollution, and mitigate the impacts of climate change. Through sustainable practices and conservation initiatives, societies can safeguard the planet for future generations and ensure a healthy environment for all living beings.

2. Topic: Technology

..... It encompasses innovations in computing, communication, and automation, driving progress and efficiency across various industries. Embracing technology empowers individuals and organizations to streamline processes, access information, and connect with others globally, shaping the future of society and enhancing human capabilities.

3. Topic: Diversity and Inclusion

..... They encompass acceptance, respect, and appreciation of differences in race, ethnicity, gender, sexual orientation, religion, and abilities. Promoting diversity and inclusion enriches perspectives, encourages collaboration, and creates opportunities for all individuals to thrive, contributing to a more equitable and harmonious society.

4. Topic: Economic Development

..... It involves initiatives to promote sustainable growth, create jobs, and enhance infrastructure and institutions. By fostering entrepreneurship, innovation, and trade, societies can stimulate economic prosperity and create opportunities for social advancement, ultimately contributing to global prosperity and stability.

5. Topic: Mental Health

..... It encompasses emotional, psychological, and social well-being, influencing how individuals think, feel, and act. Promoting mental health involves raising awareness, reducing stigma, and providing access to support and treatment services. By prioritizing mental health care and support, societies can improve resilience, productivity, and the overall health of their populations.

Q2. Label the sections from 1-10 based on the labels provided below: (10 marks)
(Introduction, Thesis statement, In-text citation, Topic sentence, Conclusion, concluding sentence, Supporting ideas, Body paragraphs, Background, Details)

Diversity: Help or Hindrance to Group Performance?

1 { In an increasingly complex and competitive business world, how is a company to generate the creative ideas needed for ongoing success? Many managers believe that forming teams with cross-functional diversity is the answer (Sethi et al., 2002), and this is becoming increasingly common (Mu & Gnyawali, 2003). However, while diversity in group membership may lead to the diversity of ideas needed for innovative problem solving, it is argued here that that managers need to be aware that there are many ways that diversity can in fact hinder team performance, though there are strategies that both teams and their managers can use to reduce the potential negatives and enhance the potential positives.

2 {

4 { Aside from the cross-functional diversity, many other types of diversity can have effects on team performance and some of these types of diversity can have inherently negative effects. For example, any negative stereotyping by group members resulting from diversity in terms of gender, age or ethnicity will reduce team social cohesion and hence group performance (Fiske & Neuberg, 1990, as cited in Harrison et al., 2002) because a certain amount of social cohesion has been found to be correlated with effective group performance (Harrison et al., 2002).

5 {

3 {

6 {

7 { Other aspects of diversity, such as in attitudes towards the group's tasks, in values, and in time management styles, can also negatively affect group social cohesion and hence group performance (Fiske & Neuberg, 1990, as cited in Harrison et al., 2002). The sorts of diversity that are most likely to be beneficial to group performance, such as diversity in relevant knowledge, experience and skills (Harrison et al., 2002), can unfortunately also cause problems for group performance.

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Having too many diverse views and opinions to coordinate can, for example, cause cognitive overload amongst group members and so impede its decision making processes (Mu & Gnyawali, 2003; Sethi et al., The cross -functional diversity mentioned above can also cause problems if group members have difficulty understanding and coordinating the differing world views and values of group members from different functional areas (Colbeck et al., 2000 and Gallos, 1989, as cited in Mu & Gnyawali, 2003).

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Given all the above-mentioned problems associated with diversity, are there strategies that a team and its managers can implement to reduce the potential negatives and enhance the potential positives? Regarding cognitive overload, evidently a team needs to be given an adequate amount of time to complete its task. Scheduling frequent collaboration can also be used to build social cohesion and overcome the potential negative impacts of stereotypes (Harrison et al., 2002) provided "team psychological safety" is fostered in the group (Mu & Gnyawali, 2003). And since too much social cohesion can cause teams to avoid the robust debate needed to generate the best thinking in order to protect social relationships, management encouragement of the group to be "venturesome" in its work can also be helpful (Sethi et al., 2002). In conclusion, it appears that if managers wish to create especially effective teams, they should seek to minimise diversity in terms of task and time management values, while looking to maximise differences in relevant knowledge and skills. They should further aim to foster as much collaboration as possible so as to develop team social cohesion, have rules about interactions which foster team psychological safety, and encourage the team to be venturesome. Unless these things are done, managers will likely find diversity more a hindrance than a help for group performance.

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1.

Q3. Paraphrasing: Re-write the following sentences in your own words. Ensure that it follows the standards of academic English. (10 marks)

1. Climate change is a major topic of discussion due to its rapid progression, raising concerns globally.
2. The emergence of new COVID-19 variants has sparked worries about vaccine efficacy, necessitating ongoing caution.
3. Geopolitical tensions between key nations have heightened, presenting significant diplomatic challenges worldwide.
4. Cryptocurrency, such as Bitcoin, has garnered significant attention, sparking debates over its potential to reshape traditional financial systems.
5. Social justice movements advocating for racial equality and police reform have gained traction globally, prompting calls for systemic change.
6. Advancements in artificial intelligence technology have prompted ethical debates regarding its societal implications and potential risks.
7. The rise of remote learning due to the COVID-19 pandemic has prompted discussions on the future of education and the effectiveness of online teaching methods.
8. The shift towards remote work arrangements has prompted discussions on the future of work dynamics and its impact on productivity.
9. The proliferation of misinformation online has underscored the need for media literacy and regulatory measures to address false information dissemination.
10. The imperative for sustainable practices and renewable energy adoption has gained prominence amid growing environmental concerns and climate change awareness.

Section C – Business Writing

(40 marks)

Q1. Rewrite the following extracts taken from business correspondence to avoid stylistic errors, and make it sound more professional (10 marks)

1. Hope you're doing good. just wanted to check in and see if you got the report i sent. let me know if you need anything, k?"
2. The meeting is postponed. Can't believe it! :("
3. Hi team, just a quick heads up - we gotta reschedule the training session. thx!
4. Dear Sir/Madam, I'm writing to complain about the service I got at your store. It was terrible!!!
5. Hey, I need a favor. Can you please cover my shift tomorrow? I owe you one. TYSM!
6. URGENT: we r almost out of stock. v low inventory. we need 2 order ASAP!!!
7. Hey, just wanted to let you know the meeting's been canceled. sorry for the inconvenience.
8. Supervisor, can't come in today. not feeling well. thx, John
9. Hey guys, I wanna get your input on the upcoming project. Can u meet @ the usual place?
10. Attention all staff!!! today's the big day! get ready for the new changes. See ya!

Q2. Cloze Passage – Professional Vocabulary

(10 marks)

Choose the best answer for gaps 1-10 from the following:

[professional, effective, strong, partnerships, informed, industry, time, quality, learning, business]

As a _____ (1), it's important to maintain _____ (2) communication with clients to ensure their needs are met. Building _____ (3) relationships fosters trust and loyalty, leading to long-term _____ (4). Additionally, staying _____ (5) on industry trends and _____ (6) developments is essential for providing informed advice and solutions. Effective _____ (7) management and prioritization of tasks are crucial for meeting deadlines and delivering _____ (8) results. Finally, ongoing _____ (9) and self-improvement are vital for staying competitive in today's fast-paced _____ (10) environment.

Q3. Select ONE (01) of the following questions and answer accordingly with appropriate business documentation. The word limit for each should be 250-300 words. Each question carries 20 marks each. (20 marks)

1. You are a purchasing manager for a retail company and you're interested in procuring a new line of products for your stores. Write an **email** to a potential supplier requesting information about their product range, pricing, minimum order quantities, and any promotional offers they might have.
2. You recently hired a catering service for an important company event, but the service fell short of your expectations. Write a **formal letter** of complaint to the catering company outlining the issues you encountered, such as delays in food delivery, incorrect orders, and poor quality of food. Request compensation or a resolution to rectify the situation.
3. You are the manager of a small company that has decided to implement a new remote work policy allowing employees to work from home two days a week. Write a **memo** to all staff members announcing this policy change. Include details such as the effective date of the new policy, guidelines for remote work, expectations for communication and productivity, and any additional resources or support available to facilitate remote work arrangements. Additionally, address any potential concerns or questions that employees may have about the new policy.